

The First Real Deadline: Consequences

第一个真实期限：后果

Theme: 求职、职场与职业发展 · New: 45 · Review: 18 · Planned cumulative progress: 45/6, 127

English Story

The consequences arrived as a **notification** on a very ordinary day. The **officer** from the council submitted a **conduct** report, and the **candidate** who had lost the **recruitment** had gone to court over it. "It was **possible**," the minister said, "that we caused this." **Indeed**, the **offer** carried a **corresponding** obligation, and nobody had read the last page. They would go back to the case and move the reason onto the record.

The **removal** of the **seasonal officer** was a **surprise**. A **competitor** with a **presidency** to protect, a **counterpart** in the other office, and a **resident** of the third **storey** all wanted a **rating**, and the **rating** obliged them to **decorate** the **cafeteria** before the visit. The **workforce** had been **seasonal** for eighteen years, and nobody had thought to tell the residents.

The work was not really **useful** to them, and that was the question: for whose job was this a service? "A **furnace** and a **gadget** are both machines," Maya said. "One heats a house, the other sells a house." The **wire**, the **lid**, and the **pig** on the poster were the only decoration in the room, and the table was covered in **outgoing** mail.

The **outgoing** chair had an **urge** to **computerize** everything and a **wish** to **instal** a new system by the winter. "We **lean** on the young **workforce**," Lin wrote, "and then we call their fatigue a **repayment**." A **suspense** of three weeks followed, and the **congratulation** that finally came was signed by someone who had never visited.

The **cause** was, in the end, an orientation: the department was built for the **orient** and not for the town, and its **recruitment** followed the same map. "That is a **proud** way to fail," the **officer** said, and everyone at the table knew that she was right. Their **clothes**, their **dress**, and their very habits in the corridor were part of the evidence. They had learned to **operate** the old system by habit, and the habit would **haunt** them for another year at least. Actually, the whole case had been in front of them for a month.

中文翻译

后果在一个非常普通的日子里，以一条通知的形式到来。委员会的那位官员提交了一份行为报告，而那位在招聘中落选的候选人已经为此上了法庭。“有可能，”部长说，“是我们造成了这件事。”的确，那份录用带有一项相应的义务，而没有人读过最后一页。他们会回到案件上，把原因写进记录。

那位季节性官员的免职令人意外。一位要保住主席职位的竞争者、另一间办公室里的对等人物，以及三楼上的一位住户都想要一个评级，而这个评级迫使他们在那次来访之前把自助餐厅装饰一番。这支劳动力队伍已经季节性存在了十八年，却没有人想到要告诉那些住户。

这份工作对他们其实没什么用，而问题正在于此：这是为谁的工作在提供一种服务？“火炉和小玩意都是机器，”曼雅说，“一个给房子加热，另一个把房子卖掉。”电线、盖子和海报上的那头猪，是屋里仅有的装饰，而桌上堆满了待寄出的邮件。

即将卸任的主席有一股冲动，想把一切都电脑化，并希望在冬天之前安装一套新系统。“我们倚靠年轻的劳动力，”林伟写道，“然后把他们的疲惫称作报偿。”随后是三周的悬念，而最终到来的祝贺，签名的是一位从未到访过的人。

原因说到底是一种取向：这个部门是为东方、而不是为这座城建的，它的招聘遵循同一张地图。“这是一种骄傲的失败方式，”那位官员说，桌边每个人都知道她说得对。他们的衣物、他们的穿着，乃至他们在走廊里的习惯，都是证据的一部分。他们已经习惯于按老办法操作这套旧系统，而这个习惯至少还会缠着他们一年。事实上，整个案件已经摆在他们面前一个月了。

Core Vocabulary · 核心词汇

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
possible 'pɒsəbl POS: a	a. 可能的, 潜在的, 合适的; n. 可能性, 可能的事物 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. something that can be done; n. an applicant who might be suitable; a. capable of happening or existing
offer 'ɒfə POS: n	n. 给予(物), 出价, 提议, 意图, 报价; vt. 提供, 出价, 奉献, 试图, 使出现, 演出; vi. 出现, 献祭, 提议, ... Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the verbal act of offering; n. something offered (as a proposal or bid); v. make available or accessible, pr...
cause kɔ:z POS: n	n. 原因, 目标; vt. 引起, 使产生, 使遭受 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. events that provide the generative force that is the origin of something; n. a justification for something...
indeed in'di:d POS: adv	adv. 的确, 实在, 真正地, 甚至 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: r. in truth (often tends to intensify); r. (used as an interjection) an expression of surprise or skepticism...
officer 'ɒfisə POS: n	n. 军官, 主管, 官员, 公务员; vt. 指挥 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a person authorized to serve in a position of authority on a vessel; v. direct or command as an officer
wish wiʃ POS: n	n. 希望, 愿望, 祝愿, 命令, 请求; vt. 愿, 想要, 希望, 祝愿; vi. 希望 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a specific feeling of desire; n. an expression of some desire or inclination; n. the particular preference t...
candidate 'kændideit POS: n	n. 候选人, 投考者; [法] 候选, 候补者 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. someone who is considered for something (for an office or prize or honor etc.)
operate 'ɒpəreit POS: v	v. 操作, 运转, 动手术, 活动 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. direct or control; projects, businesses, etc.; v. handle and cause to function; v. happen
useful 'ju:sfʊl POS: a	a. 有用的, 有益的; [机] 有用的, 有效的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. being of use or service
conduct 'kɒndʌkt, -dəkt POS: n	n. 行为, 举动, 指导; vt. 为人, 指挥, 管理, 实施; vi. 领导, 传导, 指挥 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. direct the course of; manage or control; v. lead, as in the performance of a composition; Barenboim conduct...
resident 'rezident POS: n	n. 居民, 常驻程序, 居住者, 留鸟; a. 居留的, 定居的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. someone who lives at a particular place for a prolonged period or who was born there; a. living in a partic...
clothes kləʊðz POS: n	n. 衣服 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n clothing in general; v provide with clothes or put clothes on; v furnish with power or authority; of kings or...
dress dres POS: n	n. 服装, 覆盖物; vi. 穿着; vt. 给...穿衣, 整理 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a one-piece garment for a woman; has skirt and bodice; v. put on clothes; v. provide with clothes or put clo...
lean li:n POS: n	n. 瘦肉, 倾斜, 倾斜度; a. 瘦的, 贫乏的, 歉收的; vi. 倚靠, 倾斜, 依赖; vt. 使倾斜 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. to incline or bend from a vertical position; v. cause to lean or incline; v. rely on for support; a. lacking...
surprise sə'praiz POS: n	n. 惊奇, 奇袭, 诧异; vt. 使惊奇, 撞见, 奇袭 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the astonishment you feel when something totally unexpected happens to you; n. a sudden unexpected event; n. ...
rating 'reitiŋ POS: n	n. 等级, 额定功率, 责骂; [经] 等级评定 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. standing or position on a scale
proud praʊd POS: a	a. 骄傲的, 自大的, 自豪的, 辉煌的, 壮丽的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. feeling self-respect or pleasure in something by which you measure your self-worth; or being a reason for...
submit səb'mit POS: vt	vt. 使服从, 使受到, 委托, 提交, 认为; vi. 屈服, 服从 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. refer for judgment or consideration; v. put before; v. yield to the control of another; v. yield to another's...
urge ə:dʒ POS: n	n. 冲动, 推动力, 迫切的要求; vt. 驱策, 力劝, 竭力主张, 推动; vi. 强烈要求 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an instinctive motive; n. a strong restless desire; v. force or impel in an indicated direction
wire 'waɪə POS: n	n. 电线, 电报, 电信, 铁丝网, 金属丝; vt. 用金属丝捆扎, 拍电报; vi. 打电报 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. ligament made of metal and used to fasten things or make cages or fences etc; n. a metal conductor that car...

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
pig pig POS: n	n. 猪, 猪肉, 贪婪的人, 猪一样的人; v. 生小猪, 象猪般地生活 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a crude block of metal (lead or iron) poured from a smelting furnace; v. live like a pig, in squalor
competitor kəm'petitə POS: n	n. 竞争者; [经] 竞争者, 竞争对手 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n the contestant you hope to defeat
removal ri'mu:vl POS: n	n. 移动, 移居, 迁移, 排除, 切除; [医] 切除, 除去 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the act of removing; n. dismissal from office
presidency 'prezidensi POS: n	n. 总统职权, 总裁职位 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the tenure of a president; n. the office and function of president
counterpart 'kauntəpɑ:t POS: n	n. 副本, 复本, 配对物, 相应物; [经] 副本, 正副二份中之一 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a person or thing having the same function or characteristics as another; n. a duplicate copy
decorate 'dekəreit POS: v	v. 装饰 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. make more attractive by adding ornament, colour, etc.; v. award a mark of honor, such as a medal, to
workforce phonetic unavailable POS: n	n. 劳动力; 工人总数, 职工总数 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n the force of workers available
recruitment ri'krut:ment POS: n	n. 新兵征召; [医] 募集[反应], 募集[现象] (生理), 复聪(耳科) Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the act of getting recruits; enlisting people for the army (or for a job or a cause etc.)
lid lid POS: n	n. 盖子, 限制, 眼睑; vt. 给...盖盖子 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a movable top or cover (hinged or separate) for closing the opening at the top of a box, chest, jar, pan,...
corresponding ,kɒri'spɒndɪŋ POS: a	a. 相当的, 一致的, 通信的; [计] 对应 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. accompanying; s. similar especially in position or purpose
haunt hɔ:nt POS: n	n. 常到的地方, 生息地; vt. 常到, 出没于, 萦绕于; vi. 出没, 作祟 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a frequently visited place; v. follow stealthily or recur constantly and spontaneously to; v. haunt like a g...
repayment ri'peimənt POS: n	n. 付还, 偿还, 报复, 付还的钱; [经] 偿还, 付还 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. payment of a debt or obligation
seasonal 'si:znəl POS: a	a. 季节的, 依照季节的, 周期性的; [经] 季节性的, 季节的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. occurring at or dependent on a particular season
oblige ə'blaidʒ POS: vt	vt. 强制, 施恩惠于, 使感激; vi. 施恩惠, 帮忙 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. bind by an obligation; cause to be indebted; v. provide a service or favor for someone
orient 'ɔ:rient POS: n	n. 东方, 东方诸国; a. 东方的; vi. 向东; vt. 使朝东, 使适应, 确定方向 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. be oriented; v. determine one's position with reference to another point; v. cause to point; v. familiarize (...
cafeteria ,kæfi'tiəriə POS: n	n. 自助餐厅; [经] 自助餐厅 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a restaurant where you serve yourself and pay a cashier
outgoing 'autgeuiŋ POS: n	n. 外出, 开支, 流出; a. 喜欢外出的, 即将离职的, 乐于助人的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. leaving a place or a position; a. retiring from a position or office
storey 'sto:ri POS: n	n. 楼, 楼层, 层楼 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n a structure consisting of a room or set of rooms at a single position along a vertical scale
furnace 'fə:nis POS: n	n. 火炉, 熔炉, 考验; vt. 在炉中烧 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an enclosed chamber in which heat is produced to heat buildings, destroy refuse, smelt or refine ores, etc.
gadget 'gædʒɪt POS: n	n. 小配件, 小玩意, 诡计 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n a device or control that is very useful for a particular job
notification ,nəʊtifi'keɪʃən POS: n	n. 通知, 通告, 告示; [经] 通知, 通知书 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a request for payment
suspense sə'spens POS: n	n. 悬疑, 焦虑, 悬念, 悬而不决; [经] 未定, 暂记 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. apprehension about what is going to happen; n. an uncertain cognitive state; n. excited anticipation of an a...
congratulation kən.grætʃə'leiʃən POS: n	n. 祝贺, 恭喜 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the act of acknowledging that someone has an occasion for celebration; n. (usually plural) an expression of...

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
computerize kəm'pjʊ:təraɪz POS: vt	vt. 用电脑处理, 使电脑化; [经] 给...装备电脑, 用电脑计算 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. provide with computers; v. store in a computer
instal phonetic unavailable POS: vt	vt. 任命, 使就任, 使就职, 安装, 装置, 设置, 安顿, 安置 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v set up for use; v put into an office or a position; v place